ARTOMETRICS

ISSUE 01 · FALL 2026 · THE DATA ISSUE



PADRES Record Sale, Zero Championships

ANIME Source Sets the Audience Floor

FRANCHISE Merchandise Owns the Ledger

READMITTED The 3% Stick Medicare Keeps Swinging

Contents

3

PADRES

Record Sale, Zero Championships

San Diego solved demand and the tax bill. It has not solved October. Franchise values follow the market and the ballpark anyway.



5

ANIME

Source Sets the Audience Floor

In a century of MyAnimeList data, light-novel TV adaptations draw 32 times the median audience of original series. The data also shows where fan ratings and commercial value part ways.



7

FRANCHISE

Merchandise Owns the Ledger

One hundred three Wikipedia-scraped franchises (mid-2019) sum to $1.52T lifetime revenue. Merchandise is 56% of row totals; Pokémon leads at $90.9B. By region of origin: Japan $681.5B, the US $622.6B (45 franchises, 64.6% merchandise), the UK $163.4B.



9

READMITTED

The 3% Stick Medicare Keeps Swinging

In CMS's latest Hospital Readmissions Reduction Program extract, 48.15% of hospital–condition pairs still exceed the expected readmission ratio after a decade of penalties capped at 3% of Medicare payments. This R2 report maps HRRP history, who pays, safety-net effects, observation and mortality debates, international comparators, and eight charts for hospital executives.

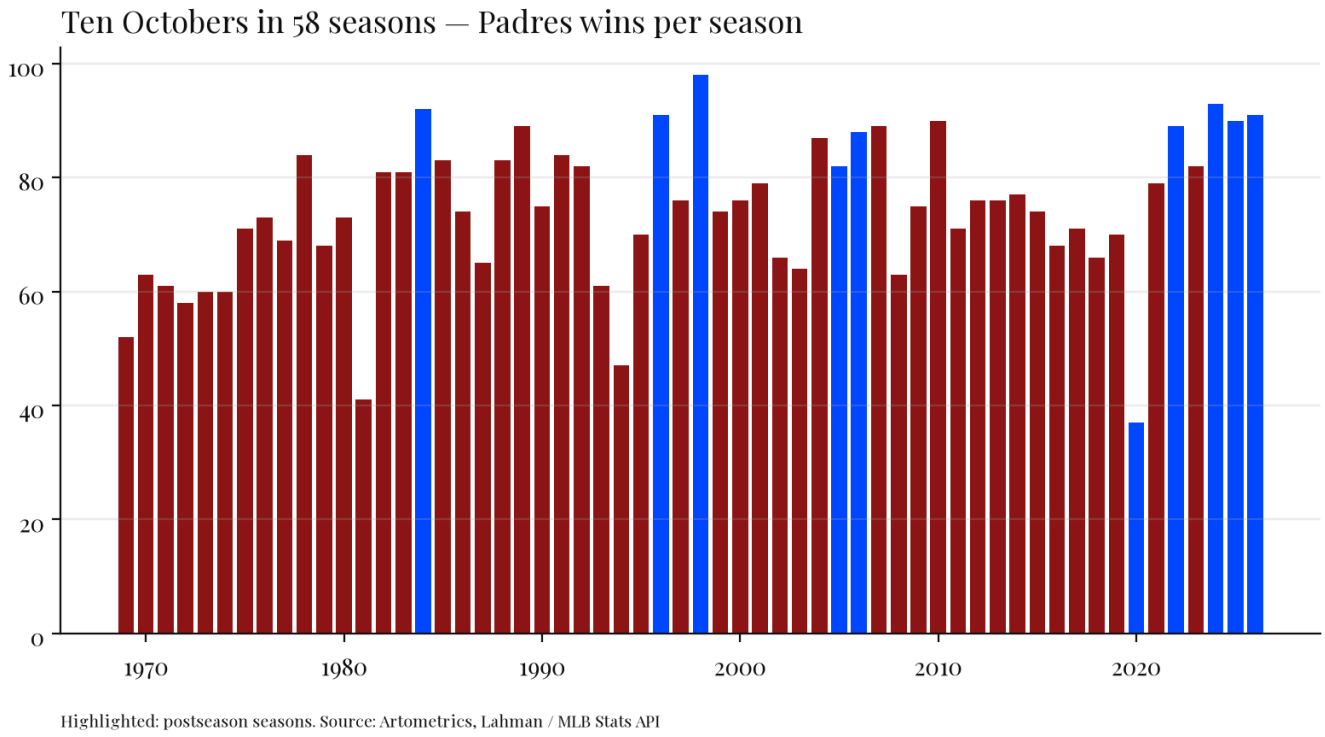




PADRES

Record Sale, Zero Championships

San Diego solved demand and the tax bill. It has not solved October. Franchise values follow the market and the ballpark anyway.



San Diego solved the two problems a mid-market club is supposed to fail. The park is full. The tax bill is paid. October is still close to a coin flip, and the franchise is on the wrong side of it. The market is paying a record price anyway. Franchise values follow the city and the building, not the trophy case. Executive summary Five findings, for an owner, a lender, or the league office.

“On August 17, 2026, Major League Baseball owners unanimously approved the transfer to José E.”

The vote is in. On August 17, 2026, Major League Baseball owners unanimously approved the transfer to José E. Feliciano and Kwanza Jones. Feliciano is the control person. Erik Greupner stays as chief executive. A.J. Preller stays in baseball operations. Associated Press and NBC 7 San Diego both reported the agreed price at $3.9 billion, an MLB record. Demand is not the missing piece. In the Lahman file the club drew 3,437,201 in 2025, second in the majors, behind the Dodgers at 4,012,470. In 2026 Baseball-Reference records 3,347,081, second in the National League. Petco's first full era, 2004–19, averaged 2,372,417. The eight seasons before it, 1996–2003, averaged 2,292,236. October is…

The so-what is the same sentence for all five. A buyer who needs a title is buying a coin flip on top of a solved market. A buyer who needs appreciation is buying the market. Alexander and Kern (2004) find that market size, a new venue, and the chance of relocation explain franchise values, and that winning barely moves the price.

The price of demand The May agreement and the August vote are the same transaction seen from two desks. The family agreed to transfer control. The owners then approved it, unanimously, on a conference call on August 17, 2026. Major League Baseball's release said closing remained contingent on the…

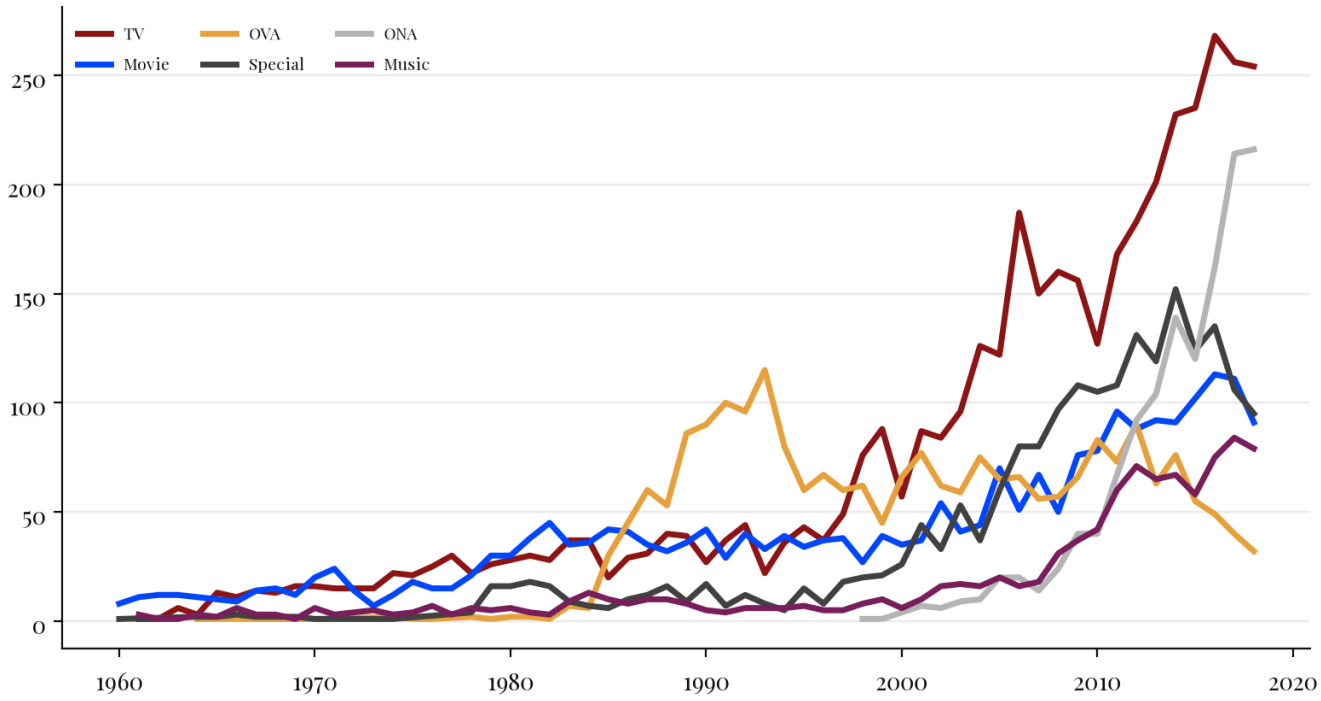


ANIME

Source Sets the Audience Floor

In a century of MyAnimeList data, light-novel TV adaptations draw 32 times the median audience of original series. The data also shows where fan ratings and commercial value part ways.

Each wave lines up with a new channel — anime titles by first year



Death Note has 1,610,561 MyAnimeList members, more than any other anime in the archive, and scores 8.66. Hanada Shounen-shi, a 2002 series from the same studio, Madhouse, scores 8.11 and has 8,929. A MyAnimeList archive of 13,631 titles, from 1917 to an early-2019 snapshot, suggests that much of a gap like that is set before anyone draws a frame, starting with where the story comes from. On television, light-novel adaptations draw a median of 153,184 platform members. Manga adaptations draw 37,500 and original series 4,738, which puts light novels about 32 times ahead of originals. Quality follows a different pattern. Only 4.6% of original TV series and 0.5% of TV game adaptations score 8.0 or higher as of the early-2019 snapshot, compared with 17.0% of manga adaptations. Across all scored titles, a title's score and its audience move closely together, with a rank correlation of 0.74. Every comparison below is measured against the overall median score of 6.38. This report reads the archive as the record of a production system, not a list of favorites. In that system, a production committee (seisaku iinkai) of publishers, broadcasters, music labels, and merchandisers pools the budget and splits copyright in proportion to each member's investment. The animation studio is typically a contracted manufacturer that doesn't own the IP (Hernández Hernández, 2018, §4.3; Mihara, 2018). The figures here are observed fan behavior on one platform. They show which projects found audiences, not which ones made money.

"It's a series of format waves, and each wave lines up with a new channel."

RESEARCH QUESTION Which decisions made before production (format, source material, studio, and whether to make a sequel) are associated with a title's reach and fan rating, and where does the platform's popularity record miss strong work?...

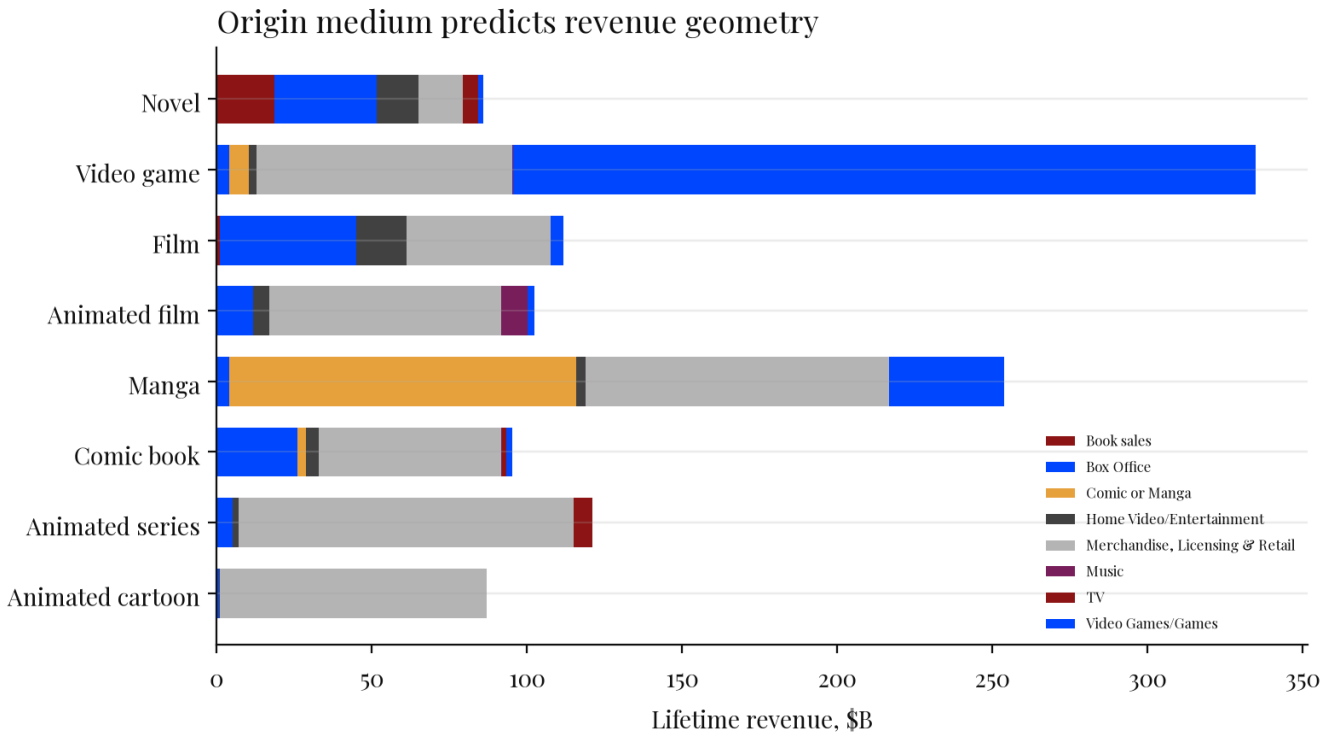
Anime output is not one growth curve. It's a series of format waves, and each wave lines up with a new channel. Theatrical film dominates the early catalog. Original video animation (OVA), sold directly on tape and disc, ran at roughly 100 titles a year from 1990 to 1993 and peaked at 115 in 1993. Television then became the core of the catalog, with 4,260 TV titles in the archive. Original net animation (ONA), made for web distribution first, grew from 40 titles in 2009 to 104 in 2013 and 216 in 2018, for 1,321 in total. The archive records release format, not financing. Reading these waves as responses to...



FRANCHISE

Merchandise Owns the Ledger

One hundred three Wikipedia-scraped franchises (mid-2019) sum to $1.52T lifetime revenue. Merchandise is 56% of row totals; Pokémon leads at $90.9B. By region of origin: Japan $681.5B, the US $622.6B (45 franchises, 64.6% merchandise), the UK $163.4B.



Executive summary. Franchise economics is licensing geometry: who owns repeatable rights, and which revenue streams compound after the premiere. In the mid-2019 Wikipedia/TidyTuesday ledger (103 properties, $1,522.2B row-sum lifetime revenue, S001), merchandise-weighted rows beat theatrical for most names; box office is 8.9% of the file. Pokémon leads at $90.9B because games, cards, and retail compound — not because it beats every stacked Marvel and Star Wars row you could add. Japan's media-mix and production-committee history explain why animation often functions as a storefront for objects; Hollywood's answer is studio-owned IP wired to parks and retail — The Walt Disney Company's consolidated franchise rows sum to $426.2B while FY2024 Experiences segment revenue alone is $34.2B (10-K, S081). The domestic top ten has become a sequel chart (90% franchise installments in 2024). Counterexamples — Universal's Dark Universe, DC slate churn, mobile peaks like Angry Birds — prove ownership without operating discipline is expensive noise.

"Both trades assume the same premise — that characters can be mined long after opening weekend."

ONE LEDGER, TWO PLAYGROUNDS A child trades a cardboard Pikachu for lunch money; Bob Iger signs a seventy-one-point-three-billion-dollar check for Twenty-First Century Fox. Both trades assume the same premise — that characters can be mined long after opening weekend. The TidyTuesday file published July 2, 2019 is our x-ray: 103 media franchises scraped from Wikipedia's "highest-grossing media franchises" list, each split across up to eight revenue streams (merchandise, box office, games, comics, and others). Figures are lifetime estimates through roughly mid-2019, not audited studio financials. They are still the cleanest public ledger for comparing how money attaches to IP — verified against franchise.csv (SHA-256 logged in verified_numbers.csv, source S001). This…

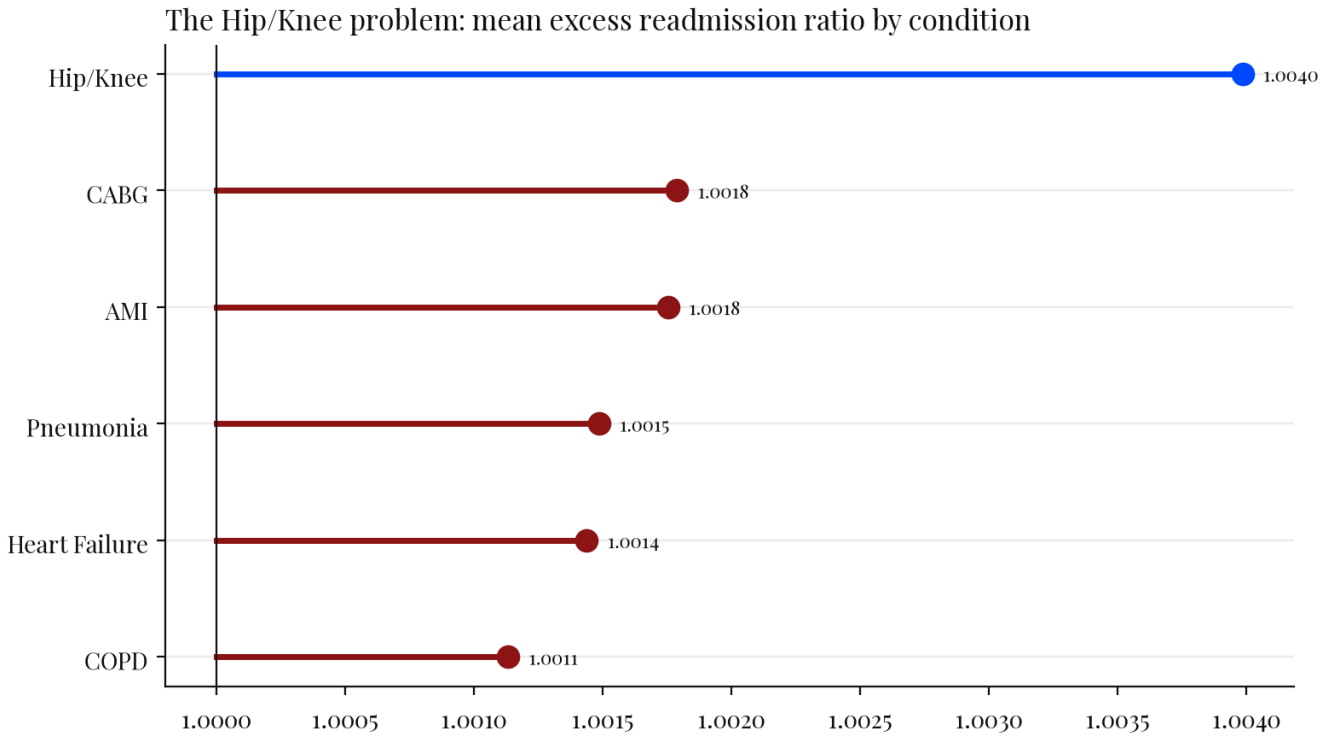
RESEARCH QUESTION For franchises in the mid-2019 Wikipedia scrape, (1) how much lifetime value sits in merchandise versus box office and games, (2) how do Japan-origin and US-origin properties differ in that mix, (3) how did paired Wikipedia estimates move by 2026, (4) how does consolidating Disney subsidiaries change the ownership map, and (5) how fast did domestic top-grossing films become franchise installments?…



READMITTED

The 3% Stick Medicare Keeps Swinging

In CMS's latest Hospital Readmissions Reduction Program extract, 48.15% of hospital–condition pairs still exceed the expected readmission ratio after a decade of penalties capped at 3% of Medicare payments. This R2 report maps HRRP history, who pays, safety-net effects, observation and mortality debates, international comparators, and eight charts for hospital executives.



In 2009, Jencks and colleagues reported that nearly one in five Medicare fee-for-service patients returned to the hospital within thirty days. Congress answered with the Hospital Readmissions Reduction Program (HRRP): starting in October 2012, CMS began shaving inpatient prospective payment system (IPPS) dollars when risk-standardized thirty-day readmissions exceeded targets for six conditions. The maximum cut rose from 1% in fiscal year 2013 to 3% in FY2015, and it applies to all Medicare DRG payments—not just the condition that missed (CMS, QualityNet; MedPAC, 2024). The October 2026 CMS supplemental extract (dataset 9n3s-kdb3, measurement window July 1, 2021–June 30, 2024) still flags 48.15% of hospital–condition pairs above an excess readmission ratio (ERR) of 1.0. ERR divides predicted readmissions by expected readmissions for each hospital's patient mix. Above 1.0 triggers penalty math; below 1.0 earns no bonus. The national mean ERR is 1.002. The program clarified the problem faster than it eliminated it.

"Penalty-timeline points for FY2025–FY2026 come from Advisory Board analyses of CMS preliminary payment-reduction files; 2012–2015 national rates follow Zuckerman et al."

RESEARCH QUESTION After fourteen years of HRRP, where do penalties still concentrate in the latest CMS file—by state, condition, ownership, and safety-net proxy—and what should hospital executives infer about transitional care, observation-status gaming, mortality tradeoffs, and CMS's shift toward episode-based models such as TEAM?...

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY What it means. Medicare still penalizes roughly half of measured hospital–condition pairs for excess thirty-day readmissions, with elective joint surgery posting the highest average ERR and for-profit systems carrying more high-tier exposure than non-profits. How we know. We rebuilt working tables from CMS HRRP supplemental data and Hospital General Information, then exported eight charts (npm run brief:readmitted). Penalty-timeline points for FY2025–FY2026 come from Advisory Board analyses of CMS preliminary payment-reduction files; 2012–2015 national rates follow Zuckerman et al. (NEJM, 2016, doi:10.1056/NEJMsa1513024). What explains it. HRRP financialized a logistics problem—discharge planning, medication reconciliation, follow-up access—without paying for the fixes. Observation stays moved returns off the inpatient ledger (Zuckerman et...